CHAPTER 12
More Discoveries

Something puzzled art scholars until recently. In Islamic tomb gardens, the mausoleum usually sits at the place where the water channels meet. But the Taj Mahal does not fit that pattern. The tomb is at the far end.

In the 1990s, scientists began to dig in the area across the river from the Taj Mahal. They cleared away silt and weeds that had grown there from centuries of flooding. Underneath they discovered something wonderful—the remnants of a magnificent garden.

Like the one at the Taj Mahal, it too once had walkways, pavilions, pools, fountains, trees, and flowers. A wall made of brick, plaster, and red sandstone surrounded the garden. Four sandstone towers stood at the corners.